



CITIZENS' CHARTER

To deal urgently with burning issues in the war on terror, we now call on you to write directly to the Prime Minister and seek decisive action. Start now.

Dear Sir,

I have joined the INDIA TODAY Group's movement to Declare War on Terror. I humbly request you to review and rationalise the security requirements and arrangements of our politicians. We understand they need protection because they have to take unpopular decisions and carry out their task without fear or favour. We have, however, seen that many treat security personnel as a status symbol. There is already a serious shortage of experienced personnel to combat terror and it would take years to train fresh recruits and meet the demand. I request you to immediately order an optimisation exercise and prune down security for politicians to the bare minimum so that trained personnel can be deployed for public security.

Yours sincerely

Concerned Citizen of India

(Sign here)

Write to the PM on your letterhead: Dr Manmohan Singh,
Prime Minister of India, PMO, South Block, New Delhi-110 011 Or
email: <http://pmindia.nic.in/write.htm>

You can also go to www.indiatoday.in/war and send it from there.

Other Ways You Can Help

Turn your concern into action. FIVE simple things you can do now, that can make a significant impact in our War on Terror:

1 WATCH THE POLICE

Be part of a resident's initiative to visit your local police station and check whether they have the requisite facilities, enough manpower and equipment to meet the challenge.

2 BE WELL PREPARED

Undergo a first-aid training course and a drill on how to deal with terrorists. Check with your civic authorities where to go. If they don't know, tell us.

3 PROOF OF ID

Start a campaign to have every citizen register under a national

ID card system and be willing to produce it when asked by proper authorities.

4 VOTE CRIMINALS OUT

Take a pledge not to elect a candidate with a criminal track record and actively canvass against such persons.

5 PAY YOUR FINES

Corruption endangers security: Instead of bribing officials, pay the fine if you are penalised for any offence.

Share your suggestions, Click to www.indiatoday.in/war or sms WAR with your suggestion, name and city to 52424



India's Views

To stop infiltration, we should make our borders more secure. There should be no compromise on this issue.

KAPIL BAKHSI, *Gurgaon*

Just as the Government has given a free hand to the Indian Navy in tackling Somali pirates, it should allow our military to fight terrorism without succumbing to US pressure.

PRIYANK DAVE, *Korba*

People should take initiative and ask the government to issue Citizen ID cards holding vital information. Such cards should be made mandatory in all big cities first. Besides, monitoring the influx of people is a necessary step.

MILIND DALVI, *Mumbai*

The Mumbai attacks have shocked all of us and there is a lot of anger against the system. This anger needs to be channelised in a positive way. The extensive use of RTI to make the system work is the need of the hour.

R.K. GARG, *Chandigarh*

We should go to the roots of the problem. We must change our economic policy so that the marginalised sections start benefiting from it. Terror funding needs to be stopped too. The UN should look into it.

MAHESH JANI, *Rajnandgaon*

There is a need for qualitative improvement in the civil and defence infrastructure, support systems—fire fighting services, ambulances and medical facilities. India Inc and the media will have to play a pivotal role.

PARTHA ROY, *Delhi*

We should boycott Pakistani products while withdrawing all measures taken in J&K to please the Kashmiris. India is not convinced with house arrests and bans. We should also arrest separatist leaders in Kashmir and bring them to justice for being anti-national.

PATANJALI, *Bangalore*